



Nivala is a municipality in Finland known for its picturesque landscapes and strong community spirit. It features a blend of rural charm and modern amenities, promoting local culture and sustainable development. The area is characterized by its agricultural activities and commitment to enhancing residents' quality of life.



Village Smartness Index



A village smartness index value of 1.0 indicates that the village has achieved the highest level of smartness in its services and initiatives. This suggests that the village effectively utilizes digital technology, innovation, and knowledge to enhance economic opportunities, infrastructure, and governance. The presence of advanced services and a strong commitment to smart transformation are evident. In contrast, other villages in the research exhibit a wide range of smartness levels, with many struggling to implement even basic smart initiatives, highlighting the exceptional status of this village.

Indicator 1.1.1



Measures the availability and quality of digital network connections within a rural community.



The calculated smart village index indicator value of 465.0 signifies a robust availability and quality of digital network connections within the rural community being assessed. This high value indicates that the community has effectively integrated advanced digital infrastructure, enabling residents to access essential services and information seamlessly. Such connectivity fosters opportunities for economic growth, enhances educational resources, and improves overall quality of life. The presence of a strong digital network is crucial for supporting various smart village initiatives and promoting sustainable development in the area.

Indicator 1.1.2



Assesses traditional, non-digital means of connectivity (e.g., postal services, telephony) to gauge infrastructure inclusivity in areas with limited digital access.



A calculated smart village index indicator value of 1.0 signifies a moderate level of development in terms of smart village characteristics. This value suggests that the village has made some progress in integrating traditional connectivity methods, such as postal services and telephony, to enhance infrastructure inclusivity, particularly in areas with limited digital access. However, it also indicates that there are significant gaps in connectivity and resources, as evidenced by the minimum value of 0.0 in other villages, which may reflect a lack of data or resources. Overall, a value of 1.0 highlights the need for further development and investment in both digital and non-digital infrastructure to improve the quality of life for residents.

Indicator 1.1.4



Examines the affordability and economic accessibility of internet services for rural residents, aiming to highlight potential barriers to digital engagement. [Internet café, libraries]

A calculated smart village index indicator value of 1.0 signifies a moderate level of smartness in the village, indicating that it has made some progress in implementing digital technologies and services. This



value suggests that while the village has initiated efforts to enhance connectivity and access to information, there are still significant gaps compared to the maximum potential of 2.0. The presence of internet cafés and libraries may provide some access points for residents, but barriers such as affordability and economic accessibility could hinder broader digital engagement. The index reflects a need for further development to improve overall digital inclusion and enhance the village's smart capabilities.

Indicator 2.1.1



This indicator measures the extent to which public transport services are available and accessible to rural populations, including frequency, coverage, and proximity of services. It reflects the inclusiveness and usability of the transport network in addressing mobility needs in sparsely populated areas.



A smart village index indicator value of 3.0 signifies a moderate level of public transport services available and accessible to the rural population in the current location. This value indicates that there is a reasonable frequency and coverage of transport services, allowing residents to meet their mobility needs effectively. The transport network is likely to be somewhat inclusive, providing essential connectivity for the community, although there may still be areas for improvement to enhance accessibility and usability further. Overall, this value reflects a developing transport infrastructure that supports the mobility of residents in the village.

Indicator 2.2.2



This indicator assesses the adoption and use of vehicles powered by low-carbon or renewable fuels, such as electric vehicles (EVs), plug-in hybrids, or vehicles running on biodiesel, in rural areas.



A smart village index indicator value of 13.0 signifies a relatively high level of adoption and use of vehicles powered by low-carbon or renewable fuels in the assessed rural area. This suggests that the village has made significant strides in promoting sustainable transportation options, such as electric vehicles and hybrids, contributing to reduced carbon emissions and enhanced environmental sustainability. The presence of supportive infrastructure, such as charging stations and incentives for using green vehicles, likely plays a crucial role in achieving this indicator value, reflecting a commitment to sustainable mobility practices within the community. Overall, this value indicates a proactive approach to integrating eco-friendly transportation solutions in rural settings.

Indicator 3.2.1



Measures the spread of localized energy generation facilities, enhancing local energy resilience.



The calculated smart village index indicator value of 0.0 signifies a complete absence of localized energy generation facilities within the village, indicating a critical gap in energy resilience. This zero value suggests that the village lacks the necessary infrastructure or initiatives to harness renewable energy sources, which are essential for enhancing local energy security and sustainability. The absence of data may further exacerbate this situation, highlighting the need for improved data collection and analysis to inform future energy strategies and development initiatives in the area. Addressing this deficiency is crucial for fostering energy independence and promoting sustainable growth in the community.